

Passing of Randall Jones, Son of Utah

High tribute has been paid to Randall Lunt Jones, who claimed Cedar City as his home, by Many people of the state. The Salt Lake Tribune voiced that sentiment in an editorial, which in part is as follows:

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The passing of Randall Lunt Jones in the prime of usefulness, at the pinnacle of his popularity, on the eve of a centennial for which he had been helping the people of his church and state to prepare, is not only a severe shock to legions of friends, and acquaintances throughout the nation, but a personal bereavement to every resident of this commonwealth.

Born March 5, 1881, at Cedar City, Utah, his boyhood is best described by Maurine Whipple, a native of St. George who became a well-known author, in her book entitled "Utah—This Is the Place." She singles him out as one who had made practical application of an infatuation for outdoor Utah developed while a lad riding herd over his father's cattle on the slopes of Cedar Mountain.

As he grew to manhood the generous minded youngster wanted all the world to see what he had seen and to love what he loved. Eventually he toured the east, preaching the gospel of western splendor and opportunities until, as the author quoted admitted, "harassing high railroad officials, governors, congressmen—the freckled youth was a cocklebur in the saddle of destiny."

When Zion national park was established and tourists began pouring through its picturesque gateway, Randall Jones decided it was time to get busy and earn a living in his chosen profession. But the Union Pacific people would not permit retirement from a situation he had done so much to create. They made him a "special representative" and assigned him to a service he loved and followed up to the tragic moment last Wednesday when he suddenly and silently departed to an unknown realm of more glorious grandeur than he had depicted or described to millions of fellow citizens and to royal audiences in Europe.

To have known Randall Jones and remember him is a pleasure for those who knew him and his mission. He was always "a boy from the rural region"—fair-minded, big-hearted, kindly disposed and public-spirited—a serious soul with a sense of humor, a devout believer who was not a bigot, a son of Utah who wanted everybody to know and to love his parental province.

Southern Utah owes him and his memory more than can be measured out in coin. To his persistence and his practical faith may be given credit for the railroad spur that carries travelers from the main line to Cedar City; for the splendid highways replacing trails over which his converts once toured that great outdoor gallery of natural pictures and statuary; for the splendid hotel which catered to guests always planning to return.

It is difficult to write of Randall Jones without thinking of his earnest voice, his modest statements, his boyish enthusiasm, his manly sincerity, his loyal devotion to friends, to groups, to communities sharing his devotion to nature. Such a man must have been envisioned by Bryant when he wrote the love of nature holds communion in Thanatopsis: "To him who in with her visible forms, she speaks a various language." To Randall Jones she talked and he listened.